

[Request] What additional trees burn down in forest fires over a years time, due to the electricity consumption, and therefore additional carbon emissions, of our most popular AI?

Posted by u/Defiant-Bat8623 • • 0 points • 3 comments

I did the math roughly myself already but would like to see if others concur or have additional variables they see I missed. Based on my rough math... it is VERY LIKELY ... MILLIONS of mature adult trees per year. That is just from the primary AI we all know by name, alone, just from it's impact on CO2 emissions, alone, not including fresh water usage, site construction, etc. Just it's electrical demand for chat usage. Not including the LLM training, just user queries.

****The rough math:****

We know the average density of average forests. Pine, Deciduous, Tropical, across the globe, per hectare.

We know the area in hectares burned down per year.

We know how much that has increased.

We know how much global temperatures have increased in Delta ° C.

We know how much of that is caused by increase in CO2 Emissions.

We know how much energy used by AI, per average chat.

We know the number of users and the average daily chats for AI.

And so, we can calculate, roughly, the number of additional trees that burned down in a given year, from just the additional CO2 emissions due to daily, and therefore average yearly Use of said AI. It comes out to be in the MILLIONS of of Mature adult trees Per YEAR.

Millions of ADULT TREES

PER YEAR??

Thousands. Per Day?? :(

Even if my rough math is off by.. 25% or 50%... it is still an insane impact on the environment.

Comments

u/nntktt • 1 points • 2025-09-21 08:40 UTC

I don't really get how you're trying to correlate number of trees burned down to the power consumption of AI models out there, because we don't really burn trees directly to generate electricity.

A quick google tells me we cut down 15 billion trees per year globally, so even if your number of millions of trees was right it's not a very significant number.

Not that I support wasting power on AI pointlessly, but I'm not seeing where this argument goes.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-09-18 18:54 UTC

[removed]

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-09-18 08:22 UTC

[removed]

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-09-18 02:01 UTC

###General Discussion Thread

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I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/theydidthemath) if you have any questions or concerns.